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FROM Parliamentary Question (Mr. Teeling).

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Dated 2 Mar 49

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Formosa.

In reply to a question by Mr. WILLIAM TEELING, Mf. BEVIN, Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, said that H.M. Consulate, at Tamsui, was in charge of a regular member of H.M. Foreign Service. In view of the Cairo Declaration, the Chinese Government had assumed the administra ttion of Formosa pending the conclusion of a Treaty of peace with Japan.

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Parliamentary Question.

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* 11. Mr. Teeling,—To ask the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, whether His Majesty's Government has a consul in Formosa or a representative accredited to the Supreme Commander, Allied Forces, Tokyo; and what arrangements for the occupation and government of Formosa are in force pending the conclusion of a peace treaty with Japan. [*Wednesday 2nd March.*]

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Brighton

ANSWERED 2 MAR 1949
REPLY ATTACHED.

The first part of Mr. Teeling's question is straight-forward. The second part, regarding British representation in Tokyo, contains the usual misstatement of fact which we have come to regard as being inevitable in all Mr. Teeling's questions. General MacArthur is not "Supreme Commander, Allied Forces" but "the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers". In any case, General MacArthur is not a government and representatives of foreign powers cannot, strictly speaking, be "accredited" to him. But as Mr. Teeling is well aware, one of Sir A. Gascoigne's primary functions is to maintain the closest possible liaison with General MacArthur and his Headquarters.

The position regarding Formosa is briefly as follows. The island was internationally recognised as being under Japanese sovereignty before the war. At Cairo on the 1st December, 1943 President Roosevelt, Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek and Mr. Churchill declared "that all the territories that Japan has stolen from the Chinese such as Manchuria, Formosa, and the Pescadores shall be restored to the Republic of China". The Heads of the Governments of the United States, United Kingdom and China reaffirmed that "the terms of the Cairo Declaration shall be carried out" in the Potsdam Declaration issued on the 26th July, 1945. The Potsdam Proclamation was subsequently adhered to by the Soviet Union. When Japan surrendered she accepted the Potsdam Proclamation and surrendered, in fact, to the four Potsdam Powers. It was as a result of agreement among these Powers that General MacArthur was appointed to be Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers "for the purpose of enforcing the surrender of Japan", and it was on the basis of a directive agreed upon by the same four Powers that Japanese forces in Formosa were eventually instructed to surrender to Chiang Kai-shek. A Chinese Military Administration was thereupon set up in Formosa and subsequently superseded by a Chinese Civil Administration which is still in existence. Thus the Chinese, in view of the Cairo Declaration, appear to have been permitted to assume the administration of Formosa (which is legally still under Japanese sovereignty) without there being any very precise international agreement on

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the subject. We ~~were~~ are aware that the Americans are at present showing great interest in the future of Formosa and that some American circles think it desirable that Formosa should be withheld from the Chinese Communists. But American intentions are not yet clarified and we clearly do not wish to be drawn into any speculation on possible future developments.

Draft reply submitted.

F. S. Tomlinson
1st March, 1949.

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FORMOSA (BRITISH CONSULATE)

33. **Mr. William Teeling** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs whether His Majesty's Government has a consul in Formosa or a representative accredited to the Supreme Commander, Allied Forces, Tokyo; and what arrangements for the occupation and government of Formosa are in force pending the conclusion of a peace treaty with Japan.

Mr. Bevin: His Majesty's Consulate in Formosa is situated at Tamsui and is in charge of a regular member of His Majesty's Foreign Service. With regard to the second part of the Question, the hon. Member will be aware that one of the primary functions of the United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Tokyo is to maintain the closest possible liaison with the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers. In the Cairo Declaration the Heads of the Governments of the United States, the United Kingdom and China declared that Formosa would be restored to China. In view of this declaration the Chinese Government have assumed the administration of Formosa pending the conclusion of a Treaty of Peace with Japan.

Mr. Teeling: If the Chinese Government have taken over Formosa temporarily, what position is our Government going to take up if by any chance the Red Government of China should get control of Formosa, since the Americans have stated that Formosa is in their line of defence?

Mr. Bevin: I must have notice of that question.

2 MAR 1949

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* 11 Mr. Teeling,—To ask the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, whether His Majesty's Government has a consul in Formosa or a representative accredited to the Supreme Commander, Allied Forces, Tokyo; and what arrangements for the occupation and government of Formosa are in force pending the conclusion of a peace treaty with Japan. [*Wednesday 2nd March.*]

Draft Reply to P.Q.
No. +11
Mr. Teeling

H.M. Consulate in Formosa is situated at Tamsui and is in charge of a ~~career~~ regular member of H.M. Foreign Service. With regard to the second part of the question, the honourable Member will be aware that one of the primary functions of the United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Tokyo is to maintain the closest possible liaison with the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers.

In the Cairo Declaration the Heads of the Governments of the United States, United Kingdom and China declared that Formosa would be restored to China. In view of this declaration the Chinese Government have assumed the administration of Formosa pending the conclusion of a Treaty of Peace with Japan.

Notes for Supplementaries

If Mr. Teeling should press for an answer to his specific question about our representation in Tokyo the answer might be:

"The Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers is not a Government and representatives of foreign powers cannot be accredited to him."

The most obvious supplementaries based upon the last part of the question would be of a hypothetical nature e.g. what would our attitude be if the Chinese Communists were to attempt to

obtain/

obtain control of Formosa? To such questions the stock answer might be given:

"I am not prepared to answer a hypothetical question."